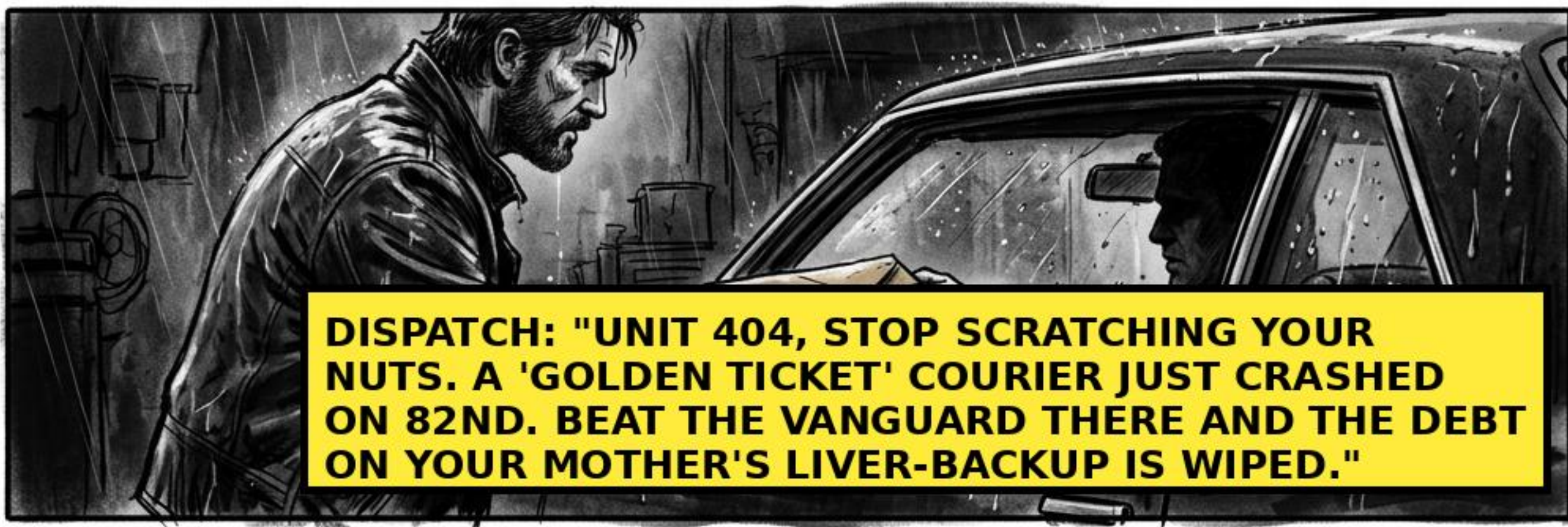


**JANUARY 1, 1980. TWO AM. THE GRID IS COVERED
IN NEW YEAR'S VOMIT AND FAILED RESOLUTIONS.**





**WIPE? BULLSH*T. BUT I KICK THE '78 LEMANS
OVER ANYWAY. THE ALTERNATOR SCREAMS LIKE A
GUTTED PIG.**



**I-95 SOUTH. IT SMELLS LIKE BURNT RUBBER AND
CHEAP CHAMPAGNE.**





I SEE THE COUNTACH EMBEDDED IN A STUCCO MANSION. THE COURIER IS PINNED TO THE DASH. HE'S DEAD, BUT HE'S STILL SMILING.

DISPATCH: "THE VANGUARD AUDIT-TRUCKS ARE TWO MINUTES OUT. GRAB THE BOX OR DIE FORECLOSED, AXEL."





THE BOX IS A HEAVY-ASS MAGNETIC SAFE. I BOLT IT TO THE REAR FLOORBOARDS. THE STEEL CHASSIS GROANS UNDER THE WEIGHT.

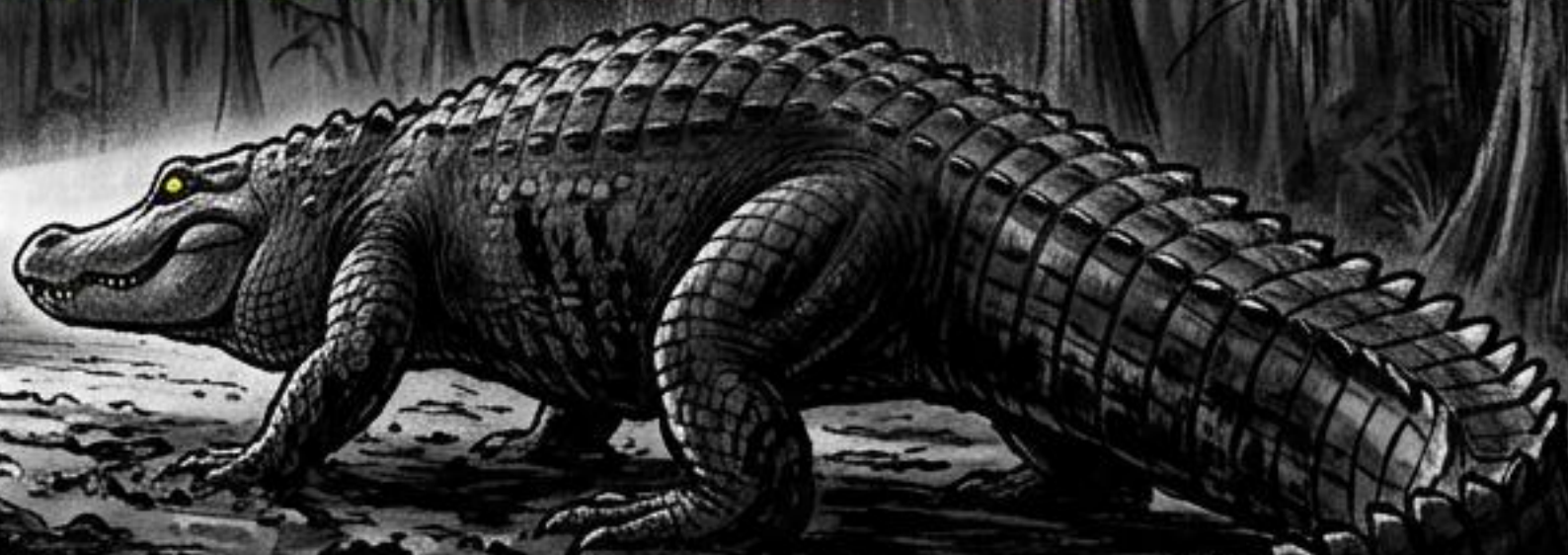
I RIPPED THE WHEEL TOWARD THE EVERGLADES. THE ASPHALT IS TURNING INTO MUD. THE SAFE IS HUMMING A FREQUENCY THAT TASTES LIKE COPPER.





DISPATCH: "WATCH YOUR TRAPS, AXEL. RADAR SHOWS A HEAT SIGNATURE ON YOUR TAILPIPE."

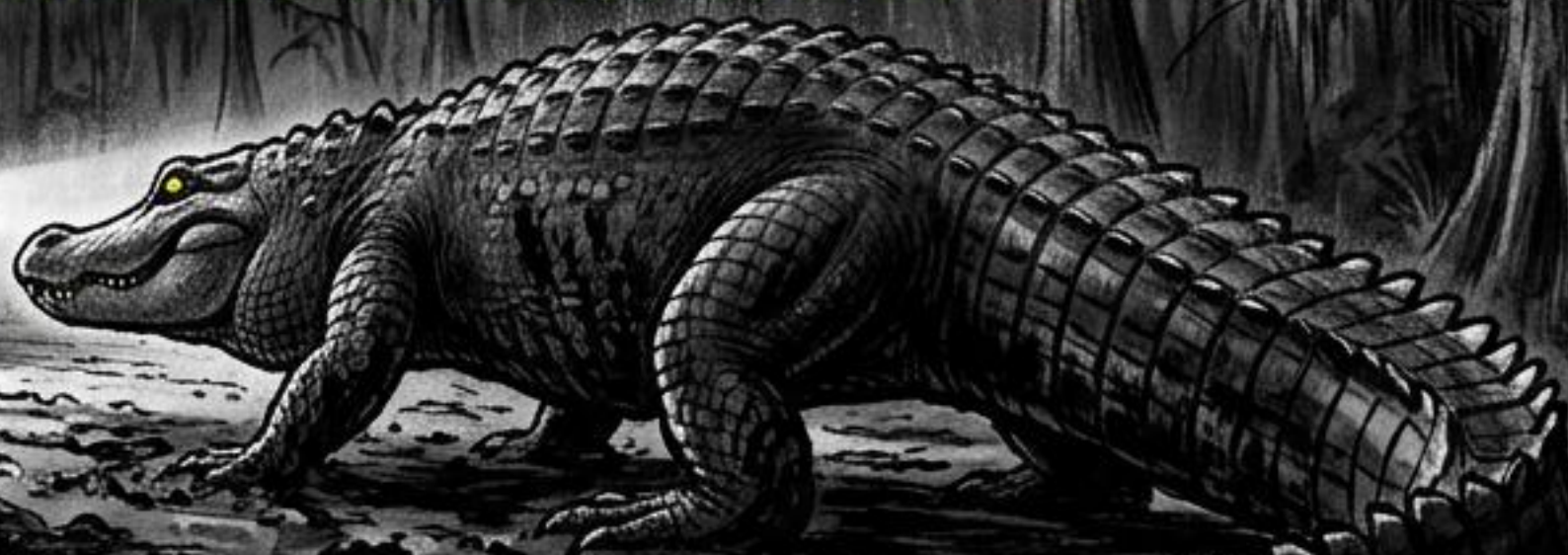
MY SUSPENSION IS BOTTOMED OUT. EVERY BUMP FEELS LIKE A KICK TO THE TEETH.





**I POP THE CLUTCH. THE V8 BACKFIRES, SPITTING
A FLAME THAT ILLUMINATES THE ROTTING
MANGROVES.**

DROPOFF. A RUSTED TERMINAL IN THE MIDDLE OF NOWHERE. FIVE SECONDS ON THE NIXIE CLOCK.



**I KEY THE CODE. THE TERMINAL SPITS OUT A
TICKET: "RECONSTRUCTION PARTIAL. DEBT RE-
CALCULATED."**



POST-CONVICTION





POST-CONVICTION



DISPATCH: "YOU'RE AN IDIOT, AXEL. YOU JUST TOOK THE GRID-TAPE. EVERY COB IN THE STATE IS GOING TO BE IN YOUR ASS FOR THIS."